Tarbiyyah Global Academy
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ONLINE SAFETY AND ACCEPTABLE USE POLICY

Safe, responsible use of Academy platforms, devices and the internet

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026 – 2027

Policy name	Online Safety and Acceptable Use Policy 2026–2027
Applies to	All pupils, parents, staff, trustees and volunteers of Tarbiyyah Global Academy
Policy owner	Designated Safeguarding Lead and Digital Lead
Approved by	Ustadh Abu Zayn Haneef Sandhar, Headteacher
Agreed with	The Chair of Trustees, Tarbiyyah Education Trust
Date of issue	1 September 2026 (version 1.1, updated 28 October 2026 for the January 2027 launch)
Next review due by	31 August 2027
Basis	New policy for online provision (replaces the device and mobile phone sections of the Tarbiyyah Secondary policies)
Read alongside	Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy; Live Lesson Protocols; Recording of Live Lessons and Use of Images Policy; Behaviour and Online Conduct Policy; Data Protection Policy; Technology and Digital Wellbeing guidance within the Health, Safety and Wellbeing Policy
Availability	Published on the Academy website and Parent Portal. Available in large print or another accessible format on request.

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1. Purpose

Tarbiyyah Global Academy exists online. Our classrooms, corridors and noticeboards are digital, so online safety is not a topic taught once a year; it is the environment in which every lesson happens.

This policy explains how the Academy keeps its platforms safe, what we expect of pupils, parents and staff, and what happens when things go wrong.

2. Scope

This policy applies to every person who uses Academy systems, and to every Academy system, including:

- the Academy's live-lesson platform (currently Microsoft Teams), joined from the Student Portal (live lessons; assignments and quizzes are in the Student Portal);
- the Academy Parent Portal, Student Portal and staff area;
- Academy email accounts and calendars;
- Safe Exam Browser, used for secure assessments;
- approved learning subscriptions issued by the Academy. It also applies to conduct outside Academy systems where that conduct affects the safety or wellbeing of a member of the Academy community.

3. Our Approach: the Four Cs

Following KCSIE, we plan online safety around four areas of risk:

Area	Examples
Content	Exposure to illegal, harmful or inappropriate material, misinformation, extremist content, pornography, self-harm content
Contact	Harmful interaction with other users, including grooming, sextortion, and adults posing as children
Conduct	A pupil's own behaviour that increases risk or causes harm, such as sharing images, cyberbullying or oversharing personal information
Commerce	Online gambling, scams, phishing, inappropriate advertising and financial exploitation

4. How the Academy Secures its Platforms

- **Academy accounts only.** Pupils and staff use Academy-issued accounts. Personal accounts are never used for teaching or contact with pupils.
- **Controlled meetings.** Only staff can create live lessons. The lobby is enabled so that only Academy accounts are admitted; anonymous or external participants cannot join.
- **Restricted pupil permissions.** Pupils cannot present, record, start meetings, create breakout rooms or remove others. Private pupil-to-pupil chat is disabled; lesson chat is visible to staff and retained.
- **Recording.** Live lessons are recorded for safeguarding and quality assurance in line with the Recording of Live Lessons and Use of Images Policy.
- **Single sign-on and multi-factor authentication** for staff accounts; access is revoked immediately when a device is lost or a staff member leaves.
- **Secure assessments** use Safe Exam Browser so that other applications and websites cannot be opened during a test.
- **Audit logs** on Academy platforms are reviewed by the Digital Lead when a concern is raised.

Filtering at home

The Academy does not control the internet connection in a pupil's home. We therefore provide parents with guidance on router-level filtering, device parental controls and safe search, and we ask parents of younger pupils to keep devices in shared family spaces. Advice is available on the Parent Portal.

5. Acceptable Use — Pupils

Every pupil (with a parent for pupils in Years 1 to 6) agrees to the Pupil Acceptable Use Agreement at enrolment. In summary, pupils will:

- use only their own Academy account and keep their password private;
- join lessons from a quiet, appropriate space, with their camera on unless the teacher agrees otherwise;
- be kind and respectful in chat, voice and work, and never share hurtful, rude or unsafe content;
- never record, photograph or screenshot a lesson, a teacher or another pupil;
- never share lesson links, codes or Academy materials with anyone outside the Academy;
- never share personal information such as addresses, phone numbers or social media accounts with other pupils in lessons;
- keep mobile phones and other devices away during lessons unless the teacher asks for them;
- tell a teacher, their form tutor or the DSL straight away if they see or receive something that worries them. Breaches are managed under the Behaviour and Online Conduct Policy. Anything that suggests a pupil is at risk is managed under the Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy.

6. Acceptable Use — Parents

Parents support safe learning at home by:

- providing a suitable device, a reliable connection and a quiet, appropriate study space;
- supervising younger children's device use and applying parental controls;
- never recording, sharing or posting lessons or images of staff or other pupils;
- keeping out of camera view and not intervening during live lessons, except to support their own child or in an emergency;
- raising concerns through the proper channels set out in the Parent Communication Charter, rather than through public posts or group chats.

7. Acceptable Use — Staff

Staff will:

- use Academy accounts and approved platforms only, and never contact pupils through personal phones, personal email or social media;
- never hold unrecorded one-to-one video calls with a pupil. Where one-to-one support is needed, the call is scheduled through Academy systems, recorded, and the parent is informed;
- teach from a neutral, professional background with no personal information visible, dressed appropriately;
- lock or end meetings correctly so that pupils cannot remain in an unsupervised meeting;

- protect personal data, lock devices when unattended, and report lost devices or suspected breaches immediately;
- report any online safety concern to the DSL on the same day. Full expectations are set out in the Live Lesson Protocols.

8. Teaching Online Safety

Online safety is taught through PSHE, Computing and Islamic Studies, and reinforced in assemblies and form time. The curriculum is age-appropriate and includes: recognising reliable information and misinformation; privacy and digital footprints; healthy online relationships and boundaries, modesty and protection from exploitation; recognising grooming and manipulation; managing screen time; artificial intelligence and deepfakes; and how to report. Islamic Studies connects online conduct with adab, guarding the tongue, and the amanah of what we see and share.

9. Artificial Intelligence

Pupils may use AI tools only where a teacher has permitted it for a specific task, and must declare how they used it. Using AI to complete assessed work without permission is academic misconduct under the Academic Integrity and Secure Assessment Policy. Staff will not enter pupils' personal data into AI tools that are not approved by the Academy, and will be alert to AI-generated images being used to bully or exploit.

10. Responding to Incidents

Incident	Response
Upsetting or inappropriate content seen by a pupil	Reassure, record, inform the DSL, contact parents, review platform settings
Cyberbullying between pupils	Anti-Bullying and Cyberbullying Policy; preserve evidence; support both pupils
Suspected grooming or contact from an unknown adult	Do not alert the adult; secure evidence; DSL refers to police/CEOP and children's social care
Nudes or semi-nudes shared	Do not view or forward; DSL follows UKCIS guidance
Unauthorised person joins a lesson	Remove, lock the meeting, report to the DSL and Digital Lead, review access logs
Compromised account or data breach	Revoke access, reset credentials, inform the Data Protection Officer within 24 hours

11. Monitoring and Review

The DSL and Digital Lead review this policy annually, together with platform settings and incident logs, and report to trustees. The policy is also reviewed after any significant online safety incident or change of platform.

Appendix A — Pupil Acceptable Use Agreement (summary for signature)

I will…	I will not…
Use only my own Academy account	Share my password or lesson links
Keep my camera on and be ready to learn	Record, screenshot or photograph lessons
Be kind in chat and in my words	Post anything hurtful, rude or unsafe
Tell a trusted adult if something worries me	Give personal details to people online
Keep my phone away during lessons	Open other apps or websites during lessons

Pupil name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____ Parent name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Approved by: Ustadh Abu Zayn Haneef Sandhar, Headteacher · Next review due: 31 August 2027 · Tarbiyyah Global Academy · A specialist education, rooted in faith